

Lost Addresses

Internet regulator ICANN (Internet Corporation for Assigned Names and Numbers) that keeps track of Internet addresses lost some of its own. Domain names **ICANN.com** and **IANA.com** were hijacked. ICANN maintains that the attack was brought under control in 20 minutes flat.



Sony's Fat Game

Sony's new game *Fat Princess* has provoked the ire of feminist bloggers over its *negative* depiction of obesity. In this game released for Sony's Playstation Network players have to rescue a princess who is being kept hostage and immobile by the enemy by continuously giving her tasty treats. An attempt at humour gone greasy, we must say.



Escape

ILLEGAL DEVELOPMENT

Ubisoft's tango with piracy

French video game developer and publisher, Ubisoft, was recently caught in a compromising situation, releasing a pirated hack as an official fix.

Rainbow Six Vegas 2 was patched earlier this month. When the publisher released a new patch for the RSV2 this month which added play modes and other goodies, customers were eager to update. Unfortunately, the patch also added a check to confirm that a CD was in the PC before the game could play. This was obviously a problem for customers who downloaded the game through the Direct2Drive download service and lacked physical media to validate.



Naturally, this theft prevention tool was not a problem for software pirates. A hacked executable removing the CD-check was soon available, although Ubisoft understandably forbade and punished discussion of the

crack on its Web site forums when Direct2Drive customers came for help and advice. However, they soon came up with an official fix.

A Ubisoft employee uploaded a fix to the company's support site that

Whatever Happened To... Digital Video Express

Digital Video Express (DIVX, oddly enough) was a competitor to the reigning DVD format and was propped up by retail chain Circuit City in the US. Customers needed to buy a special DIVX player which came with a modem, encryption microchip and flash memory and use it to view movies and content. Once 48 hours were up after the play button was pressed, the disks automatically locked down and became unusable. If the movie was worth seeing over and over again the customer could connect to a central server and pay designated amounts to unlock longer viewing windows.

While on paper the system seemed workable, in practice the format flopped badly, mainly because the cost of the technology was prohibitive. Another thing which might have triggered the collapse was the strong online opposition by various interest groups. This was in 1999 as the technology became unnecessary as torrents and video on demand became popular.

Even though DIVX died out, the idea behind it finally got implemented a little differently in Digital Rights Management. Seems like this one can afford to be smug from beyond the grave.

Win!

My Desktop

No Winner!
Better luck next time!

Participate in this contest and win next month

.net Interview Questions
by Nagaraju B
Published by

WILEY-INDIA



Send us your desktop with a description of how you made it to **mydesktop@thinkdigit.com** with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.

DigiPick of the month

The 1G iPhone



Last month's winner:
Deodutta Kulkarni

Participate and win next month:
Linux Command Line and Shell Scripting
by Richard Blum
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WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with "DigiPick" in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, **on or before the 20th of this month** to **digipick@thinkdigit.com**. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

was actually a hack written by software pirates to defeat the disc-check.

Officials added that they do not support or condone copy protection circumvention methods like this, and this particular incident is in direct conflict with Ubisoft's policies. Companies that take an iron fist approach to fighting software piracy are generally best served by not lifting a pirate group's code themselves to fix their own product.

Users on Ubisoft's official forum where discussion of these cracks is forbidden alerted the company to the fact that R6Vegas2_fix.zip was actually a cracked version of the executable modified by a pirate group. The file has since then been removed from the Web site. The officials further said that their UK support team has got nothing to do with it and if it is an executable file, then it surely has an

external source.

How about that? They used a file that was, technically, someone else's IP. So they pirated from pirates to defeat their own copy protection. It is popular opinion that by stealing the code, Ubisoft has acknowledged that piracy, at least when it concerns them, does indeed have shades of grey. It is amusing that a company that invests so heavily in security has taken the route of piracy.

ANGRY OLD MAN?

Torvalds Bad-mouths OpenBSD Devs

Linux creator Linus Torvalds has labeled makers of the OpenBSD operating system a "bunch of masturbating monkeys," as part of a wider critique of what he said was self-centred behavior in the

IT security industry.

The row started earlier over a Gmane mailing list, when a developer for the PaX Team, which patches the Linux kernel, accused Torvalds and other top Linux kernel developers of covering up the security impact of bugs by not clearly labelling them as security flaws. Well, that was more than enough to irk Linus and have his version ready. In response, Torvalds wrote that disclosing the bug itself was enough, without having to label each individual security flaw. In an e-mail to the Linux kernel developer mailing list, Torvalds said a section of the security industry was dedicated to finding bugs in software only to publicize their findings and gain notoriety.

"I don't think some spectacular security hole should be glorified or cared about as being any more "special" than a random spectacular crash due to bad

People Who Changed Computing

Paul V. Mockapetris

In the early 1980s, Mockapetris created the Domain Name System (DNS), the key name registration basis for the Internet. Besides allowing simple domain names, DNS also routes mail,



Paul V. Mockapetris

balances loads across multiple servers, and offers a growing list of new tasks, such as routing VoIP phone calls and suppressing spam. Mockapetris received two bachelor's degrees (in Physics and in Electrical Engineering) from the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) in 1971, and his PhD in Information and Computer Science from the University of California, Irvine in 1982. In 1978, Mockapetris joined ISI, where he later created the first SMTP e-mail server. Mockapetris was program manager for networking at ARPA in the early 1990s, supervising efforts such as gigabit and optical networking. In 2005, he won the ACM Sigcomm Lifetime Award for his work as an Internet pioneer and the 2003 IEEE Internet award for his DNS work.